

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 6 4

♥ K 7 4

♦ T 7 3

♣ Q J 3

♠ A Q J T

♥ A 6 5

♦ A Q 8 5

♣ K T



♠ 7 5 3

♥ Q 3

♦ K J 6 2

♣ 8 5 4 2

♠ 9 2

♥ J T 9 8 2

♦ 9 4

♣ A 9 7 6

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

entries. Your obvious entries are the ♦ K and ♦ J. If West holds only two small ♠s with his ♠K, then two entries will be enough. But what if West holds ♠ K x x x ? Can you find a third entry to dummy?

If the ♦s split 3-2 the answer is **YES**. Play the ♦ A, then lead your ♦ 8 to dummy's ♦ J. Watch carefully to see if both defenders follow to this trick. They do. Play a ♠ to your ♠ T, which holds the trick. Play your ♦ Q to dummy's ♦ K. Finesse the ♠ again. Return to dummy by playing your ♦ 5 to dummy's ♦ 6, then finesse the ♠ one last time.

If the ♦s had split 4-1 you would not have been able to enter dummy three times. That would have been very unlucky.

If you played your ♦ 5 too early you would not have been able to enter dummy three times even when there was a 3-2 split. That would have been very unsmart.

With 20 HCP and balanced distribution you should open 2NT. Do not let the good 4-card ♠ suit sway you to anything else. Partner bids 3NT and everybody passes.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♥ J. You try the ♥ Q, but West plays the ♥ K.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 4 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 6

You need 3 more winners and at least 2 of them must come from ♠s. Furthermore you don't want West to lead ♣s through your King. Your best hope is that West holds the ♠ K so you can finesse.

So you win the ♥ A and start thinking about dummy entries. Your obvious entries are the ♦ K and ♦ J. If West holds only two small ♠s with his ♠K, then two entries will be enough. But what if West holds ♠ K x x x ? Can you find a third entry to dummy?

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ T 8 5 4 2

♥ Q 9 5

♦ K 8 5

♣ 8 3

♠ K J 3

♥ J 8 3

♦ 7 4

♣ J T 9 5 4



♠ 7 6

♥ K T 7

♦ Q J 6 2

♣ Q 7 6 2

♠ A Q 9

♥ A 6 4 2

♦ A T 9 3

♣ A K

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

2NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Those two entries can only be the ♠K and ♠J. So you absolutely **MUST** win the first trick in your hand with the ♠A. Then play the ♣ A K. Over to dummy by playing ♠9 to ♠J. Lead the ♣J to drive out the ♣Q. Win whatever they return and play ♠Q to ♠K to reach your two good ♣s.

When you need dummy entries you may need to win a trick in your hand with an unnecessarily high card - like in this case.

You can only win 3 ♠ tricks however you play it, so you play to suit your entry needs.

You have 6 HCP and a 5-card suit. Although you can't be sure, there is a good chance your hand will be useful to partner.

So you bid 3NT.

The contract would be 3NT played by North.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♠4. You play dummy's ♠3 and East contributes the ♠6.

You can get them in ♣s, but only if you are careful.

After you unblock the ♣ A K you will go to dummy and play the ♣J. Then, after the ♣Q is driven out you will return to dummy for the two ♣ winners. That means you need **TWO** dummy entries.

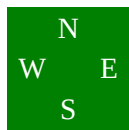
Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 9 3
♥ J 9 8
♦ Q T 7 2
♣ K 7 5

♠ A J 5
♥ A 6 3
♦ A K 6
♣ J T 9 2



♠ K T 8 6 2
♥ Q T 4
♦ J 8 4 3
♣ 6

♠ 7 4
♥ K 7 5 2
♦ 9 5
♣ A Q 8 4 3

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North
at trick one. Do you win or hold up?

You should assume that East holds the ♠K.

If you take the ♠A right now your ♠J 5 will provide a second stopper if it is East who gets the lead. However, if West gets the lead he will play through your holding and you may lose 4 ♠ tricks.

If you hold up you can expect West to play another ♠ through your ♠A J and East will then establish the suit. However, in doing so he will remove any ♠ held by West.

The answer key lies in the ♣ suit. You will be finessing through East, so West is the only defender who can get the lead in ♣s. Therefore you must hold up on ♠s until the third round.

If you win the first ♠ West will play a ♠ through your ♠J 5 when he wins the ♣K. East will then swamp you with ♠s.

But, if you hold up your ♠A until the third round, West will have no ♠ left when he wins the ♣K.

With no 4-card Major suit you respond 2♦ to partner's Stayman bid. Partner now bids 2NT.

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With a full 17 points you accept partner's game invitation and bid 3NT.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♠6 on which West plays the ♠Q.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 6

You need 3 more tricks, obviously coming from the ♣ suit.

But the burning question right now is what do you do

Board 4

North Deals

None Vul

♠ T 9 4

♥ 5

♦ Q 9 6 2

♣ A T 9 7 2

♠ A Q 3

♥ K 7

♦ A J T 4

♣ K 8 6 5



♠ 8 7

♥ A 9 8 6 2

♦ K 7 5

♣ Q J 3

♠ K J 6 5 2

♥ Q J T 4 3

♦ 8 3

♣ 4

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by South

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 4

When you are 5-5 in the Majors you can transfer to either suit. Most will say transfer first to ♥s when you have invitational strength. So you bid 2♦.

Partner says 2♥;

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Partner says 2♥;

Now you show your other 5-card Major by bidding 2♠. This one hits the spot and partner raises to 4♠.

South plays 4♠. West leads the ♥5. East takes the ♥A and returns the ♥6 which West ruffs. West then plays the ♦2.

That's an odd way to show the second ♥ loser but you get the idea. You've lost 2 tricks already and it doesn't look like you can dodge the ♣A. Soooooo, you cannot afford to lose a ♦ trick.

Take dummy's ♦A and then play ♠A, ♠K, relaxing a little when both defenders follow suit both times.

Play your three high ♥s, discarding all three ♦s from dummy. Play your ♣ toward the ♣K. West will no doubt grab his ♣A but the rest will be yours, since you can ruff your ♦ loser in dummy.

It was a little unlucky to suffer that early ♥ ruff.

But it was very very lucky that the ruffer happened to be the defender with three trumps!

That meant you could pull trumps with two pulls, leaving that one important one in dummy.